

Maranatha Meditation

John Main, the Benedictine monk who developed this meditation practice, writes, “The all-important aim in Christian meditation is to allow God’s mysterious and silent presence within us to become more and more not only *a* reality, but *the* reality which gives meaning, shape and purpose to everything we do, to everything we are.”

Maranatha is an Aramaic word that is used as a prayer in the Bible. It can be interpreted three ways: “Our Lord, Come!” “Our Lord has come.” And “Come, O Lord!”

You can begin with 5 minutes of meditation and work your way up to John Main’s recommendation of 20 to 30 minutes twice per day.

For more guidance on this meditation, see KF teachings week 6 through 10, as well as John Main’s book, *Silence and Stillness in Every Season*.

Method

Begin this practice by sitting upright and as still as you can. If you are ill, fatigued, or are holding a baby, sit propped up with pillows. Breathe as you lightly close your eyes.

Silently, within your own mind, begin to slowly say the word, maranatha. MAA-RAA-NAA-THAA. You can let it roll on the breath like the swell of the sea, or you can simply give each syllable a second or two of focus. Remember to breathe.

As you say the word within yourself, listen. Continue to say the word slowly and listen to the word throughout the meditation time. If your mind wanders, gently draw it back to the word. Try to let go of the sense of passing time and just relax into the word. Begin.

At the end of your meditation time, pause and gently bring your mind back to your environment. Take a few deep breaths as you open your eyes. You are training your mind, body, will, and heart to wait upon the Lord.